

FX Technical Update

US dollar strength stalls; the price action looks more like bullish consolidation than a trend reversal

- EUR/USD pauses above the 1.0597 Oct 78.6% retrace after the early-Apr pattern breakdown. The price action favors a continued bearish near-term bias, with next support at 1.0533-1.0542 and 1.0405-1.0483. We continue to view the 2023-2024 broad range as a distribution pattern, which favors a more significant break to the downside this year. Short-term resistance sits at 1.0694-1.0724. The medium-term tone stays negative while below 1.0811-1.0888.
- EUR/JPY bounces from the 163.11 50-day moving average, which makes the range below the 165.36 cycle high look more like bullish consolidation. An upside break would seek the 166.44-167.67 resistance zone. We've been looking for a medium- to longer-term bearish trend reversal in early 2024. The market needs to weaken through 159.70-160.21 to suggest that view is gaining material traction.
- The GBP/USD slide effectively meets initial support at 1.2339-1.2365. Even if the pair rebounds, the short-term trend bias stays negative while below 1.2518-1.2539 breakdown and 1.2572 moving average resistance
- USD/JPY maintains bullish trend dynamics for now with next resistance at 156.05, 155.27, and then 157.12. A whipsaw back through the 151.945 form cycle peaks and 149.795-150.292 support cluster is required to derail the broader trend momentum.
- AUD/USD keeps a bearish short-term bias while below the 0.6482 break and 0.6535 pair of moving averages. Near-term downside targets rest at 0.6238-0.6286.

Technical Strategy

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EUR/USD bearishly consolidates after the early-Apr breakdown

EUR/USD weakness stalled after the pair tested the **1.0597** Oct 2023 78.6% retrace, and the market has traded sideways ever since that initial test on Apr 16 (Figure 1). Importantly the sideways price action followed the early-Apr break through Nov-Mar pattern support at **1.0694-1.0724**, and the current holding pattern has developed below that breakdown area. In our view, those developments keep bears in control and favor further price weakness in the days/weeks ahead. Next support sits at the **1.0542** Dec channel and **1.0533** related Dec-Mar equal swings objective. More significant medium-term support sits in the **1.04**-handles, which had acted as range support through 2023. Continue to view that pattern support as a neckline for a broader distribution, which points to more significant weakness in the months ahead and once broken. Longer-term support sits at the **1.0246** Nov-Apr pattern target and **1.02** Sep 2022 61.8% retrace. Those are our minimum downside objectives for the year. That is followed by the **1.01** 2023 top pattern objective. Conversely, a sustained break above the **1.0811-1.0852** confluence of moving averages and **1.0888** Dec channel trend line would table the bearish medium-term outlook. Other resistance rests near **1.10**, which the market respected through 2024. Longer-term range resistance remains in the high-**1.12** area.

Figure 1: EUR/USD pauses above the 1.0597 Oct 78.6% retrace after the early-Apr pattern breakdown. The price action favors a continued bearish near-term bias, with next support at 1.0533-1.0542 and 1.0405-1.0483. We continue to view the 2023-2024 broad range as a distribution pattern, which favors a more significant break to the downside this year. Short-term resistance sits at 1.0694-1.0724. The medium-term tone stays negative while below 1.0811-1.0888.

EUR/USD, daily bars with momentum divergence signals



Source: J.P. Morgan, CQG

EUR/JPY bounces from short-term support and keeps the broader rally structure intact

EUR/JPY stages an intraday rebound from the **163.11** 50-day moving average to keep the Mar-Apr trading range intact that developed after the pair set a **165.36** Mar 20 new cycle high (Figure 2). The price action also keeps the Dec-Apr bull trend in gear and looks more like bullish consolidation than a short-term reversal pattern. An upside breakout would seek next resistance at the **166.44** Dec-Feb equal swings objective, **167.59** Aug-Oct 2023 internal trend line, and **167.67** Mar-Apr range pattern measured move objective. Longer-term resistance sits at the **169.97** Jul 2008 peak and **170.44** longer-term trend channel. We've been looking for a turn in the medium- to longer-term cycle in 2024, but that end-of-cycle reversal has been elusive so far. Tactical support remains at the **162.18-163.10** area. Next support sits at the **160.80** 100-day moving average and **160.21** Mar 11 low. A break through the **159.70** 200-day moving average would mark the first sign that the favored trend reversal is taking hold. The first layer of medium-term support rests at the **154.67** Jan 2023 38.2% retrace and **153.86** Dec low.

Figure 2: EUR/JPY bounces from the 163.11 50-day moving average, which makes the range below the 165.36 cycle high look more like bullish consolidation. An upside break would seek the 166.44-167.67 resistance zone. We've been looking for a medium- to longer-term bearish trend reversal in early 2024. The market needs to weaken through 159.70-160.21 to suggest that view is gaining material traction.

EUR/JPY, daily bars with momentum divergence signals



Source: J.P. Morgan, CQG

Cable keeps a negative short-term bias while below 1.2518-1.2572

GBP/USD decelerates as the slide following the early-Apr break through **1.2518-1.2539** pattern support closes in on initial targets that include the **1.2365** Oct 61.8% retrace and **1.2339** 4Q23 base pattern high (Figure 3). Even if the market tries to bounce from that area, the short-term tone stays negative as long as the pair is trading below the aforementioned breakdown levels and the **1.2572** 200-day moving average. Other resistance sits at **1.2639-1.2657** moving averages and the **1.2710** Apr 9 high. A move above the latter would derail the medium-term negative bias. On the downside, the Nov-Apr distribution pattern has a **1.2166** measured move objective, which sits just above other medium-term support that includes the **1.208** Fibonacci retracement confluence, **1.2037** Oct 2023 low, and **1.9161** summer 2023 pattern objective. That is our minimum downside target zone for the months ahead.

Figure 3: The GBP/USD slide effectively meets initial support at 1.2339-1.2365. Even if the pair rebounds, the short-term trend bias stays negative while below 1.2518-1.2539 breakdown and 1.2572 moving average resistance.

GBP/USD, daily bars with momentum divergence signals



Source: J.P. Morgan, CQG

USD/JPY closes in on next resistance at 156.05-157.12

While the **USD/JPY** rally has stalled for a few days, there is no evidence on the chart to suggest the market is at risk of an imminent downside trend reversal. Having cleared the key **151.945** 2022-2023 cycle peaks in early-Apr, we suspect the associated inertia can carry the pair further (Figure 4). Next resistance rests at the **156.05** Mar 2023 internal trend line, **155.27** Jan-Dec 2023 .618 swing objective, and **127.12** Dec-Mar equal swings objective. We've been looking for a medium- to longer-term bearish reversal to set up early in 2024, but a resilience in the data has kept that view from materializing up until this point. Late-cycle needs to transition to end-of-cycle for what appears to be a mature USD/JPY longer-term rally setup to reverse, and there is little sign of that in the US jobs market data that would allow that transition to take hold at the moment. On a near-term basis, USD/JPY keeps a positive trend bias while above the **151.945** highs now and other support clustered at **149.795-150.292**. It would take a break below that to do significant damage to the broader trend, in our view.

Figure 4: USD/JPY maintains bullish trend dynamics for now with next resistance at 156.05, 155.27, and then 157.12. A whipsaw back through the 151.945 form cycle peaks and 149.795-150.292 support cluster is required to derail the broader trend momentum.

USD/JPY, daily bars with momentum divergence signals



Source: J.P. Morgan, CQG

After failing to follow other cyclical markets higher in Feb-Mar, AUD/USD looks vulnerable to further weakness following the early-Apr pattern breakdown

AUD/USD looks vulnerable to further downside pressure after the failed attempts to follow other cyclical markets higher in Feb-Mar and the more recent breakdown through range support as a global risk-off trend took hold. Tactically, the tone stays negative while below the **0.6482** Apr 2 low and **0.6535** converged 100-day and 200-day moving averages (Figure 5). While below that resistance, we think the setup favors a drop to next support at the **0.6286** Feb-Apr pattern objective, **0.6278** Dec channel, **0.6269** Oct 2023 trough, and **0.5238** Dec-Mar equal swings objective. The uptrend line from the Oct 2022-Oct 2023 lows also traverses that area. A break through that could have medium-term longer-term bearish implications. Bigger picture, we've favored a retest of broader range support in the **0.61**-handles this year driven by the chart setups and DM yield curve inversions, which point to a late-cycle environment. While the US dollar strength has largely been driven by the other side of the dollar smile, we are also mindful that the curve dynamics may eventually take hold and snap that trend support to the other side of the smile. As noted above, a decisive break below that 2022-2023 pattern trend line on the AUD/USD chart, a cyclically sensitive pair, could mark a tipping point in that macro dynamic. Alternatively, a mean reversion and whipsaw back into the former 2024 trading range would turn our attention to channel resistance at **0.6617**, then the levels that capped the Jan-Apr price action, at **0.664-0.668**.

Figure 5: AUD/USD keeps a bearish short-term bias while below the 0.6482 break and 0.6535 pair of moving averages. Near-term downside targets rest at 0.6238-0.6286.

AUD/USD, daily bars with momentum divergence signals



Source: J.P. Morgan, CQG

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